

Renamed

Nanopoint Technology Inc, the manufacturers of power supply units have changed the company name to Abertek Company Limited

TRIED & TESTED

Hitachi Deskstar 7K1000.B

1000 GB with this Hitachi

Hard drives with a couple of gigabytes of space are now a thing of the past. A typical desktop today comes with 250 to 320 GB but capacities have again started shooting upwards. One of the desktop drives with a terabyte of space is the internal hard disk from Hitachi – the Deskstar 7K1000.B.

Performance-wise this drive is pretty good. In HD Tach 3, we got some nice read and write results with a decent random access time. Also, the CPU utilisation was at 2 per cent, normal in most hard drives these days. SiSoft Sandra gave us lower results in comparison to HD Tach and also a much higher random access time. We can't be certain which of these tests are lying to



us, but what we can do is check out the performance it has with real world file transfer tests, which of course was also done here with 4 GB sequential and assorted data. The tests show us that this hard drive can actually read standard alone files the best.

With the actual bytes to GB conversion, this 1-TB drive actually holds a total of 931.51 GB which is expected when it comes to hard drives. However, considering that it is priced at Rs. 9,100, we really don't

think you should buy it, especially when cheaper 1.5-TB drives are already available.

Specifications:

Dimensions: 147 x 101.6 x 26.1 mm (L x B x H), Interface: SATA 3.0 GBps, Cache: 16 MB

Ratings (on 10)

Features: 7
Performance: 7
Build quality: 8
Value for money: 5.5
Overall: 6.5

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email: lalit.sudrik@cyberstarindia.com

Web site: www.hitachigst.com / www.cyberstarindia.com

Price: Rs. 9,100 + taxes

Mercury 1990TWA

Displaying great value-for-money

The Mercury 1990TWA is another 19-inch LCD screen, but at a cheap price. 19-inch screens have become a standard for every desktop PC built. In general, the design gives the screen a simple, yet elegant look. The stand is pretty small and it isn't the most stable screen around.

The screen has a matte finish and supports the typical resolution of 1440 x 900. With the screen properly setup and calibrated, it looks pretty good. Colours aren't very saturated but contrast ratios are pretty decent. Banding is visible in high quality videos because of the TN panel in use. It is most visible in scenes with the gradient of the sky. DisplayMate tests performed well but there was a fine high-pitched sound that could be heard in

some patterns. There were no issues with the display though.

The screen has inbuilt speakers but they aren't loud enough for movies. They get the job done for light music listening for users sitting next to the screen. Quality isn't special either. Still, at Rs 6,700 it's a steal for a 19-inch display. Quality-wise, it isn't too far away from of the expensive brands and if you're on a tight budget and considering a CRT monitor instead, this 19-inch screen might change your mind.

Specifications:

19-inch widescreen, Maximum resolution supported: 1440x900 at 60Hz, built-in speakers; Dimensions: 439 x 365 x 190 mm



Ratings (on10)

Features: 8
Performance: 7
Build Quality: 7
Value for money: 7
Overall: 7

Contact: Kobian Pte Ltd

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Web site: www.mercury-pc.com

Price: Rs. 6,700

Maya 2009

Mighty Modeler

Autodesk's Maya 2009 has been released and we've had a chance to touch on some of its countless features. Here's what we think of it.

Maya has been better known for its particles effects and inbuilt simulation systems. The cloth, fluid and particles features have been upgraded a bit. Copying of properties from a rig to another rigged model is made simpler as well. There have been even more additions to the package in that aspect and it's things like this that make up the new software.

Maya 2009 continues to be expensive investment but it's a complete suite meant for professional studios. All of these

features are necessary in such places but for smaller studios, it's a very expensive software to consider and it's for them that it's not very good value for money. There are cheaper suites and for beginners, there's always the Maya Learning Edition or other free 3D modelling applications.

Requirements:

32-bit Maya requires a 32-bit Windows platform, Internet Explorer 6 or higher or other browsers, Pentium 4 or higher, AMD Athlon or higher, 2 GB memory, 2 GB disk space, OpenGL supported card.



Ratings (on10)

Features: 9
Performance: 7
Ease of Use: 6
Value for money: 5
Overall: 7

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Price: Rs. 1,07,200 (Autodesk Maya Complete 2009 Commercial New SLM) / Rs. 2,42,450 (Autodesk Maya Unlimited 2009 Commercial New SLM)